

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

Below is an extract from an article about an online writer:

Online Writer Rises to Fame

The Midnight After is a 2014 Hong Kong satirical horror comedy film directed by Fruit Chan and starring a wide cast of actors. The film is based on the web-novel, *Lost on a Red Mini Bus to Taipo*, by the 25-year-old Hong Kong writer nicknamed “Mr. Pizza”, who first became famous on the Internet forum HKGolden.

Lost on a Red Mini Bus to Taipo is about a bunch of passengers who are lost in a parallel world – where the surroundings remain the same, yet all humans have disappeared. It was first serialized online from February to July 2012 and then published in book form in July 2012. Against all odds, the book, which contains adult themes and strong language, sold 30,000 copies at the Hong Kong Book Fair.

Pizza, who is a big fan of American writer Stephen King and the US television series *Lost*, decided to create his own sci-fi novel with a local touch. He wrote the novel using local slang to relate to the online community. The story became an instant hit and was one of the three bestsellers at the book fair.

While Pizza welcomes feedback and criticism, some internet users left unreasonable and nasty comments. He admits that it took some time to get used to that aspect of writing online. He describes some of the hateful comments as “like you are writing something in your room, but suddenly someone comes in and shouts at you in your face”.

As members of the school magazine, you are preparing for an article on how to be an online writer. You may want to talk about:

- the advantages of writing online
- the problems faced by online writers
- whether there should be censorship of what is published online
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like reading online?
2. Have you read any online stories?
3. Have you ever posted things you have written online?
4. Do you think people can write whatever they like on the internet?
5. Why do online stories appeal to young people?
6. Do you think online fiction will replace print fiction?
7. What do you think about posting online comments?
8. Should online fiction be free?